

Problem Statement 1: Stress & Workload Manager

Lifestyle Track: Beating the Burnout

Stress & Workload Manager

Background:
Uni students are juggling a lot at once with assignments, part-time jobs, social commitments, errands, plus just keeping up physically and mentally. It's rarely one big thing that causes burnout. It's everything piling up together without anyone noticing until it's too late.

The problem:
Most students don't really know how much they're carrying at any given point, or which part of their life is actually overloaded. So they keep saying yes to things, put off the stuff that feels less urgent, and end up running on empty before they realise what happened.

What the solution should solve:
Build an app that gives students a clear picture of their load across different areas (mental, time, physical, social, errands) and actually helps them do something about it before burnout hits. It shouldn't just track and report. Instead, it should help students rebalance what they're carrying and push them toward recovery, like rest or getting out of the house. Make sure it's usable, accessible, and something students would actually keep open on their phone.

Examples of features:
For example, think of a workload visualiser showing load by category, with something like "You're at 90% capacity this week" as a quick sanity-check. A stress tracker to log how you're feeling over time. A load balancer that groups tasks together and pushes back lower-priority ones when things get hectic. And some kind of recovery nudge, suggesting sleep, downtime, or a hangout when someone's clearly overloaded. Teams are free to build any features with any tech that fits.

Problem Statement 2: Travel Planner

Lifestyle Track: Planning an Escape

Travel Planner

Background:
Planning a trip means dealing with flights, places to stay, budgets, activities, and whatever everyone in the group actually wants to do, and that's before anything changes at the last minute. It's a lot to hold together, and it usually ends up scattered across five different apps and a group chat.

The problem:
Most travel apps only handle one piece of this with either bookings, or budgeting, or itineraries. So travellers end up manually piecing it all together themselves. Group trips make it worse, since getting everyone's schedules, budgets, and preferences to line up is genuinely difficult. And when something changes mid-trip, there's rarely any real help from existing platforms in adjusting.

What the solution should solve:
Build something that helps people plan a trip from start to finish with budgeting, building an itinerary, syncing preferences across a group, and adjusting plans when things don't go as expected. It should make planning faster and less stressful, and work well whether someone's travelling solo or with a group.

Examples of features:
Could include AI-generated itineraries based on budget and interests, tools for groups to combine preferences and split costs, the ability to re-plan on the fly if a flight gets delayed or plans fall through, and live pricing and availability through maps or booking APIs. Teams are free to use any tech stack to realise their vision.

PROBLEM STATEMENTS

What do current stress & workload management apps do?

1. They usually focus on either task management, mood tracking, or calendars, instead of combining them into one app.

2. They often measure workload by the number of tasks, without taking into account the mental and difficulty aspects.

3. They focus only on organising tasks without tracking workload, so users are unable to easily identify when they are overloaded.

4. They mostly reward users as they keep completing more tasks, which could lead to burn out instead of suggesting them to rest when overloaded.

5. Mental health suggestions are not specific enough, such as 'taking a break', rather than giving actual solutions on how to rebalance workload.

What do current travel planning apps do?

1. They typically embed either a calendar app or a maps app or both into the main UI.

2. They force itineraries into one strict path, with no flexibility.

3. They don't take into account multiple user suggestions. A new travel planning app should be able to balance each persons preferences.

4. All locations are set by the user(s). Suggestions for additional destinations are usually by nearby locations only, not taking into account user preferences.

5. When discussions between members in a group trip, potential destination ideas are lost or forgotten in the hectic planning of it all.

6. There is no single source of truth for planning a trip, they are split between group chats, DMs and across many social media apps.

Idea 1: Bakery Store

Each **life category** (e.g. social, academic) = a **type of pastry** (e.g. donuts, shio pan). Users can choose which categories are represented by which pastries.

Number of pastries (pastry stock) = **energy level** of a category

- Example: 10 pastries = 100% energy level

Pastry stock is calculated based on the number of tasks, duration, difficulty, urgency, etc.

- Lower pastry stock means the user is focusing too much in that category and might get burnt out, so the app gives suggestions for the user to recover or reduce workload.

Uses a **kanban board** and **calendar** where users can add tasks, events, and routines to calculate workload.

- Tasks**: used in kanban board, for things that have progress (e.g. assignments, chores)
- Events**: displayed in calendar, has a fixed date/time (e.g. club events, appointments)
- Routines**: displayed in calendar, for events that repeat (e.g. classes, monthly appointments)

Choice

Pros:

- Uses gamification to make time management and task organisation more entertaining.
- Encourages users to maintain productivity in many categories without being burnt out from excessive workload.
- Provides a clear overview of the workload every day so that users can make necessary adjustments to plans.

Cons:

- Difficult to calculate workload amount accurately since many factors could affect it.
- Users might forget or be unmotivated to add tasks or events often, leading to poor workload estimates.
- May cause users to feel unproductive when their pastry stock has been full for a long time.

Final Decision: *Rejected*

- Workload calculation is complex and could be affected by too many factors, where some of them cannot be estimated accurately through numbers.
- Requires a lot of frontend designing which could take away time that could be better spent on improving the main app idea.

Choice

Pros:

- provides multiple backup plans for on the fly decision making during the trip, unique and simple method of presenting travel itinerary
- centralized source of discussion for travel plans, travel discussions should not be split across different chatrooms, prevents ideas from being forgotten by utilizing AI to note down potential destinations

Cons:

- technically difficult to execute, requires many different technologies such as collaborative software, AI and real-time communication through meetings
- requires users to ideate through meetings online to access AI node making technology

Final Decision: *Accepted*

- Instead of using the typical calendar/list format, the decision tree provides a more flexible way to visualize different travel plans and backup options.
- The decision-tree structure naturally encourages users to consider backup destinations and routes instead of relying on a single rigid itinerary and supports uncertainties or situations that occur in real time.

Idea 2: Story Board

Instead of formulating travel itineraries in terms of calendars or lists, opt to formulate an itinerary in terms of a **story decision tree**, where different paths represent backup plans/alternative destinations.

To solve the issue of potential travel ideas split between several sources, support **In-App meetings** as a **single source of truth and discussion room** for all travel ideas and discussions, while allowing users to enter in their travel ideas manually as well.

To combine the two features, include an **AI node maker** to jot down the ideas formed in the discussion meetings, and attach them to the **story decision tree**.

Additional Features

Smart Ticket and Itinerary Management: allow users to manage their ticket information

- System will read the PNR / Booking Number, Airline, Seat number, Departure Airport and Arriving Airport

Case 1: Travel by plane

Case 2: Travel by bus / train / other transportations

- Collect departure and destination, departure time and estimate time of arrival

Real - time flight updates : allow users to receive the information for their flights

- Connects with live aviation trackers for gate, gate changes, departures/ arrival delays, baggage claim

inspiration

The idea of **In-App meetings** were based around the concept of council meetings with an assigned secretary to jot down notes about the meeting.

They can prevent information and potential ideas being lost during brainstorming sessions, but in this scenario the "secretary" is the AI.

The idea of the **decision tree** is derived from story-based games which have different endings based on different choices the player picks along the story.

In real life, it mimics the same structure where there **won't always be a correct singular travel path**, rather a combination of multiple different decisions along the way based on the specific conditions at the current moment.

Kanban Board

Purpose: To organise tasks written in post-it notes.

Functionality: Split into 3 main sections, but users can add their own additional sections:

- To Do
- Ongoing
- Completed

Displayed as a general board that includes tasks for all categories, but category filters are available to display only certain tasks.

Task Creation:
Users can include information like deadline, estimated time taken, estimated difficulty, priority, categories, tags (fixed/flexible), etc.

Task Completion:

- When the task is moved to 'completed', users can optionally fill up a mini post-task reflection including information like the actual time taken, difficulty, etc. for more accurate pastry stock estimates.
- Older completed tasks moves to an archive box each week to avoid cluttering up the completed section.

Calendar

Purpose: To show events, routines, and task deadlines, which are colour-coded to match their respective category colours.

Gives a visual overview of the user's workload for each day

Suggestions Jar

Purpose: To give personalised notes to the user when there is a low pastry stock in any categories.

Suggestion Examples: Suggests to put tasks on hold, take a break, take a whole day off, etc.

- Will only suggest to move tasks with the 'flexible' tag, rather than the 'fixed' tag.

Additional Features

Reward System:

- Gives the user 'money' each day if they maintain the pastry stock within a certain amount (4-8 pastries). They earn money depending on how long they keep it within that pastry stock.
- Too many pastries = unproductive (unless they were recently overloaded)
- Too less pastries = might get burnt out
- Money could be used to decorate the bakery or character.

Daily check-in:

- At the start and end of each day, users fill up a small form including their current energy level, stress, mood, sleep, etc.
- Helps to estimate the pastry stocks more accurately depending on how the user feels on that day.

Bakery Opening and Closing

Functionality: Bakery automatically opens and closes based on the user's sleep schedule.

- User can manually open or close the bakery early.

Purpose: To represent active and recovery hours of the user.

- Opening the bakery represents active time, where the user is awake and will deplete the pastry stock if they are working on tasks.
- Closing the bakery represents recovery time, where the pastries get restocked a certain amount depending on how long it is closed for.

The app may reward the user for closing early when they're overloaded with work.

Bakery Reports

Purpose: To provide a summary of the user's progress and workload in the form of daily, weekly, and monthly reports.

Gives the user a clear overview of which categories were most overloaded, the rewards earned, trends in workload, etc.

Additional Feature: Give suggestions for how the user can improve the following day or week.

1. Setup

Purpose:

- provide basic information regarding the trip and the people joining the trip.

Collaborators:

- the main user can set up the travel plan and invite their fellow travel mates as collaborators.

Setting up the travel plan:

- setup the basic travel info
- such as the general travel location if it exists (ex. a country or city)
- each user can enter their daily / total budget as well as their home address to find meeting points when the trip starts

2. Discussion Rooms (In-App Meetings)

Purpose:

- act as a single source of truth for all travel plan discussions
- avoid travel plan discussions being split between multiple different group chats and DMs

AI note taker:

- Present during discussion rooms to note down the potential destinations/plans during the discussions.
- Creates **Nodes**
- Nodes formed by the AI will be shown in the chatbox, where users can add additional information.

nodes:

- represent a single destination/location that could be visited during the trip.
- placed into different categories: **Sightseeing, Restaurants, Historical Monuments, Shops, etc.**
- Additional information entered by the users: **Google Maps Link (location), Specified budget for specific location, Additional Pictures (ex. menu prices), user who suggested**
- Nodes can also be created and deleted manually without a meeting

3. Decision Tree

Purpose:

- present all potential destinations during the trip in a single decision tree
- Each day of the trip will have its own decision tree

nodes:

- the decision tree will utilized the aforementioned nodes (destinations/locations)
- Nodes will branch out to different nodes, each branching path represents different potential travel plans

arrows:

- connects between nodes
- represents a **travel method** (ex. public transport, car, walking, e-hailing etc.)
- the estimated travel time is represented by the length of the arrow
- each travel method will have an estimated price
- Nodes can have multiple arrows connecting to it, representing different travel methods towards that destination

Main path:

- users can select a main travel route, representing the final plan for the trip
- in the case plans fall through or an unexpected situation occurs, the different branching paths can be seen as backup plans or contingencies

4. Budget Tracker

Purpose:

- based on the currently selected main path and the estimated spending on each travel destination and method
- a full financial plan will be detailed below each day of the decision tree
- Users will be notified when the estimated spending is overbudget for each travel mate

5. Trip Mode

Purpose:

- Serve as a **reliable travel plan** during the actual trip, allowing users to switch routes or plans on the fly.
- Users can **attach images and short notes to each destination** as memories.
- Users can **save receipt pictures and expenses** to track and split bills later.

FEATURES

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